

1. Were there specific criteria Jesus used in calling His disciples?
2. Why do you think Jesus chose Judas as a disciple despite this knowledge?
3. What are your thoughts on the idea of Jesus calling Judas as His disciple?
4. How does this story relate to your own life?

1. Jesus' criteria for calling His disciples appeared to be based on various aspects, including their willingness to follow Him, their potential for faith, and their openness to His teachings. In the Gospels, we see that Jesus called fishermen, tax collectors, and others from diverse backgrounds. It seems that He sought individuals who were earnest, willing to leave their old lives behind, and had the potential to learn and spread His message. He often looked for people with a humble heart, readiness to serve, and a desire for spiritual growth.

2. The decision to choose Judas as a disciple, despite foreknowledge of his eventual betrayal, raises complex theological questions. One perspective could be that Jesus included Judas to fulfill the prophecy and to demonstrate the realities of free will versus divine foreknowledge. By including Judas, He showed that even someone who would betray Him could be given the opportunity for redemption, reflecting the themes of grace and mercy. Additionally, Judas' presence among the disciples served to highlight the dynamics of human nature and the potential for both good and evil within each person.

3. The idea that Jesus chose Judas as His disciple illuminates the profound mystery of free will and predestination. It raises questions about the nature of discipleship and the potential for transformation, even in individuals who may seem unworthy by conventional standards. This choice underscores the complexity of human relationships and the idea that we all have the potential for both good and bad choices. It can serve as a reminder that followers of Christ are not perfect and that betrayal can come from within one's close circle.

4. The story of Judas can resonate with many people's lives in various ways. It serves as a reminder of the complexities of human relationships and the

struggles we face with trust, loyalty, and forgiveness. In my own life, I might reflect on the times I felt betrayed or let down by someone I trusted, as well as instances where I may have acted in ways contrary to my values. This story can encourage self-reflection on personal choices, the nature of forgiveness, and the importance of compassion, both for ourselves and for others who may err. It speaks to the reality that we are all capable of flaws, and the journey of faith is one of continual learning and growth.